

# MyBible Extra Module Registry Specification

Revision 2023-06-01

## History of Changes

Revision 2022-10-04

- Initial state.

Revision 2023-06-01

- Corrected accidentally broken links to a sample module.
- Corrected a couple of noticed typos.

## Overview

MyBible extra module registry is a means to distribute MyBible modules created by someone outside of the core MyBible team, in such a way that modules become normally available in the MyBible's "Modules" window.

MyBible for Android supports extra module registries starting from the version 5.5.0.

## The Process

Here is how an extra modules registry is intended to be used.

A **creator** of modules needs to do the following:

1. Create modules according to the [MyBible Modules Format](#).
2. Host created modules on a server, so that each has a stable direct downloading URL.
  - a. Usage of Dropbox is handy for this.
  - b. A file URL that Dropbox provides can be turned into a file direct downloading URL by replacing the prefix "www." with the prefix "dl." and by removal of the suffix "?dl=0".  
For example, here is sample Dropbox-generated file link:  
<https://www.dropbox.com/s/rrqw5lr0wl91dfw/SMPL.zip?dl=0>  
and here is the file direct downloading URL derived from it:  
<https://dl.dropbox.com/s/rrqw5lr0wl91dfw/SMPL.zip>
3. Create an extra module registry file describing the modules ready to be downloaded and used.
  - a. Follow the extra module registry structure described below.
  - b. For every module in the registry specify its direct downloading URL (see above).
4. Host the extra module registry file, so that it has a stable direct downloading URL. There are options of hosting an extra registry file:

- a. JSON text file as is. For example, "Romanian translations.registry.json". An advantage of this approach is that the extra module registry file is very easy to update, and in case of Dropbox usage for hosting the changes become immediately available via the stable downloading URL.
  - b. A zip file with a SON extra registry file in it. Note that it makes sense to compress an extra module registry file into a zip only if its size is hundreds of kilobytes or more - which is not likely, as an extra module registry file is not expected to be big.
5. Test the setup:
- a. Add the extra registry file to MyBible, using its stable downloading URL.
  - b. In MyBible, try downloading and using every module registered in the extra module registry.
6. When updating modules, update the corresponding "update\_date" field in the registry (to ensure a module after-updating) and, desirably, also the "update\_info" field - as a courtesy for users and a history record.

A **user** of an extra module registry needs to do the following:

1. Obtain from the creator a desired extra module registry direct downloading URL.
2. Use the URL similarly to the item 5 above.
3. In MyBible settings, enable the modules auto-updating, so that when the creator updates some module (and records the newer last update date for in the extra module registry), MyBible automatically downloads the update.

Collateral information:

- a. Auto-updating of modules in MyBible occurs during the first usage session of a calendar day.
- b. A downloaded module update replaces the old copy of this module during a clean MyBible start - either after an explicit exit via the menu or after a night time of not using it (this approach prevents complications and crashes possible when updating a module that is currently in active use).

## Extra Module Registry JSON Structure

The JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) format is a close to optimal compromise for data readability by both a human and a computer. So for simplicity of maintenance, it is possible to maintain an extra module registry directly in its JSON format (i.e. without storing data in an Excel table and having some scripts to generate an extra module registry JSON).

An extra module JSON is a self-describing file: its common part contains the original URL where it can be downloaded from and its target file name to be used in the MyBible modules directory. This serves a purpose of simplifying the sharing of extra module registry with others.

The extra module registry JSON contains a common part and a list of modules.

```
{
  "url": "<URL where this extra module registry file content can be downloaded from>",
```

```

"file_name": "<name>.registry.json",
"description": "<Description to be shown in the list of extra module registries>",
"modules":
[
  {
    "download_url": "<URL where the module can be downloaded from>",
    "file_name": "<file name of the module, see details below>",
    "language_code": "<language code, see details below>",
    "description": "<a module description, in the module language or in English>",
    "update_date": "<Last module update date, in the format YYYY-MM-DD>",
    "update_info": "<Module update comments, for one or several last updates>"
  },
  ...
]
}

```

**file\_name** of a module. This field carries information on a module abbreviation (the beginning part) and an optional module type (a suffix part). It may or may not contain the .zip ending suffix; it is more natural though to always include it, thus repeating in this field the name of the file being actually downloaded. Examples: "DHNT'85+.zip" (a Bible module), "IGRB.bundle.zip" (a bundle module), "IGRB.bundle" (same as the previous but without the .zip suffix) .

**language\_code**. Android-specific language code of a module. This typically indicates a language in which the major part of the module content is written. This attribute shall be omitted or contain an empty string for modules that are language-neutral, e.g. reading plans, cross references.

# Example

```
{
  "url": "https://dl.dropbox.com/s/ykjhyxqx7xc2itu/Zhuromsky.registry.json",
  "file_name": "Zhuromsky.registry.json",
  "description": "Modules by Victor Zhuromsky",
  "modules": [
    {
      "download_url": "http://s2.igrnt.info/MyBible/.mb_private_repo/m/IGRBh+.zip",
      "file_name": "IGRBh+.zip",
      "language_code": "grc",
      "description": "Подстрочная греческо-русская Библия гебраизированная под ред. В.
Журомского (редакция рабочая).",
      "update_date": "2020-07-21",
      "update_info": "(2020-07-16) Published"
    },
    {
      "download_url": "http://s2.igrnt.info/MyBible/.mb_private_repo/m/IGRNT.bundle.zip",
      "file_name": "IGRNT.bundle.zip",
      "language_code": "ru",
      "description": "Шрифты для перевода В. Журомского",
      "update_date": "2019-06-17",
      "update_info": "(2019-01-21) The Greek font has been changed\n(2018-10-15) LCV theme
was added\n(2018-03-21) Published"
    }
  ]
}
```